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A day of commemoration — and concern

State leaders, past and present, mark advent of health care law amid warnings

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

On the 20th anniversary of the law that revolutionized health insurance in Massachusetts, political leaders and health officials sounded the alarm that affordable and accessible coverage is in peril.

“We face a cost crisis,” Governor Maura Healey said at a Faneuil Hall ceremony on Monday marking Romneycare’s anniversary. “Our nation’s health care system is broken, and Washington’s not going to fix it, certainly not anytime soon. And that’s a revolution I think we need to lead again, right here from Massachusetts.”

The Trump administration is instituting limits on federal health insurance subsidies and on who qualifies for financial aid. Additionally, rising costs for insurance users and the employers who help pay for their policies are making health care harder to access.

The result, health care officials said in interviews, is Massachusetts’ near-universal health insurance coverage is at stake.

Yet Monday’s event was also about celebrating Romneycare. Former governors Deval Patrick, Bill Weld, Michael Dukakis, and Mitt Romney joined Healey at Faneuil

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SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey joined former governors Deval Patrick, Mitt Romney, William Weld, and Michael Dukakis at Faneuil Hall.

Trump draws ire of clergy in Mass.

Local religious leaders rebuke president for his blunt criticism of pope

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF
and Aayushi Datta
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Religious leaders in Massachusetts on Monday sharply rebuked President Trump’s unprecedented attacks on Pope Leo XIV, criticizing the president’s comments as disrespectful and out of line with the moral teachings of the faith.

►Recent rants spark mental health concerns. **A2.**

Trump’s criticism came two days after Pope Leo denounced the “delusion of omnipotence” he said is fueling the US-Israeli war in Iran, and a week after the pope decried the president’s threats to destroy Iran’s “whole civilization.”

“It is hard for me as a Christian to understand what he is doing because none of that bears any resemblance to the Christianity that I know,” said the Rev. Laura Everett, the executive director of the Massachusetts Council of Churches.

The president on Sunday night delivered an extraordinary broadside against the pope, saying he didn’t think Leo is “doing a very good job” and that “he’s a very liberal person,” while also sug-

CATHOLICS, Page A5



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Kenia Guerrero, pregnant with the couple’s fourth child, sat before images of her husband, Daniel Flores-Martinez, and kids.

Tremors from volatile ICE arrest, deportation still shake Chelsea family

Father now in Mexico; his wife sues ICE over ‘cruel smash and grab tactics’

By Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

CHELSEA — Kenia Guerrero and her three children used to perk up with joy when they came home from a long day to find her husband’s work truck parked in their driveway.

Not anymore.

Now it’s an impulsive, fleeting joy, followed by the sad, sinking reality that Daniel Flores-Martinez isn’t coming home. His truck never leaves the driveway.

Flores-Martinez, 40, an undocumented immigrant, was deported to Mexico last year after US Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents pulled the family’s SUV over

while they were on their way to church on Mother’s Day.

The agents smashed his passenger’s side window, opened the door, and threw him to the ground. He was arrested, stunning his family. The volatile encounter was caught on video. His children shrieked and sobbed in the backseat. Guerrero repeatedly asked, “Who are you looking for?”

Flores-Martinez was held at a detention center in Rhode Island for more than a month. Facing deportation, he opted in June to self-deport. The government flew Flores-Martinez to Texas and bused him into Mexico.

He now lives with his grandmother in

FAMILY, Page A7

‘It’s hard looking at my kids, and I feel bad for him, because he’s on his own.’

KENIA GUERRERO, *speaking after her husband, Daniel Flores-Martinez, left for Mexico*

The saga of the impounded MBTA cars

Customs held delivery from China as Rep. Neal feared for loss of Springfield jobs

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — It was St. Patrick’s Day, and a who’s who of Washington politicians with Irish roots had assembled at the Friends of Ireland Luncheon on Capitol Hill.

Among them, Representative Richard Neal of Springfield. But he wasn’t there just to glad-hand; he had a mission, one written on a piece of card stock.

The longtime Democratic powerbroker’s objective was to get the ear of White House chief of staff Susie Wiles. After a long career in politics, the 77-year-old knew better than to open the conversation with a political ask.

“We’re all cheering for your health,” Neal recalls telling Wiles, who had recently been diagnosed with breast cancer.

Then he got down to brass tacks: Over the

MBTA, Page A6

HARBORING HOPES



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

Tugboat captain Mike McDevitt is fighting the state over a family home on Peddocks Island, a home that he hopes will become a museum. **B1.**

Paying for parking?

As Cambridge officials weigh an increase to residential street permits, other towns and cities balance actual, political costs

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

How much should a 120-square-foot rectangle of asphalt on a public road cost?

For Boston residents, the answer has long been, and likely will continue to be: nothing.

In Cambridge, however, the price to park on the street in your own city could go up substantially. The home of Harvard is mulling a proposal to triple its annual rate for some next year, from \$25 to \$75. Neighboring Somerville, meanwhile, has an impending \$10 bump for its annual pass.

The politics and policies of public

street parking vary wildly in Greater Boston. Some communities, including the state’s largest city, allow residential parking for free. Others charge fees, but the amounts are all over the map. Some charge \$10 for 10 months of parking and offer free residential parking for the other two months, while in one affluent suburb, renting a municipal overnight spot could cost you \$1,200 a year.

The different approaches reflect an inherent tension spanning space availability, the cost of a public good, and the politics of assessing a fee. The chief question: How much, if anything, should motorists pay to park

PARKING, Page A6



Sun; bursts

Tuesday: Warm, storm late. High 75-80, low 60-65.

Wednesday: Ditto. High 72-77, low 52-57.

Sunrise: 6:05. Sunset: 7:24.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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The US military began its blockade of all maritime traffic to and from Iranian ports in the Persian Gulf, but European countries rejected helping. **A3.**

Representative Eric Swalwell announced he is resigning after allegations that the California Democrat sexually assaulted a former staff member. **A4.**

Victor Orban, the populist leader, lost in Hungary for a basic reason: He stopped being popular. **A3.**

Harvard sought a new federal judge in the latest effort by the Trump administration to punish the university over allegedly failing to protect students from antisemitism. **B1.**

The Spanish government is expected to open a trade office and create a venture capital fund based in the state. **D1.**